Chapter 5 analyses the economic impact – both in terms of the immediate cost demonetization imposed on the economy and its more long-lasting effects. As data emerged, the government reluctantly acknowledged that there had been some limited adverse impact of the note ban, but insisted that this was, and would remain, only transient. While only time will disclose the long-term impact of this move, evidence points to a clear fall in GDP over two consecutive years, significant job losses, and declining investment.

In fairness, any policy measure should be judged against the objectives that it had set out to achieve. Though it is clear that demonetization caused great disruption and distress to millions of Indians and delivered a massive shock to the Indian economy, did it achieve any of its stated goals?

Chapter 6 presents objective, factual data from Government of India sources to enable the reader to arrive at a conclusion on the Report Card of India's 2016 note ban.

Demonetization has been described by some as a courageous and visionary step; by others as a reckless gamble; and by its staunchest critics, as a disastrous and badly implemented decision, which instead of flushing out black money, became a massive money laundering exercise.

I hope the objective and factual analysis of what, on evidence, should be called India's infamous demonetization, and the stories of the human suffering and drama that ensued from this decision, will help the reader in arriving at a conclusion on its consequences, on India's economy and politics.